

The key factor that separates successful bloggers from the unsuccessful ones is commitment. Of course, success can be defined in many different ways but for the purposes of this chapter we consider a successful blog as one that has hundreds of thousands of daily visitors. A blogger who is successful with his blog (or blogs) has primarily committed himself to being passionate about his interest and providing visitors with relevant information. Note that at this stage revenue is not an issue. Transitioning from just sharing your passion on a subject to actually making money from your passion may sound simple but in actual practice, there are complications.

When you are passionate about blogging, you may find that you have ambivalent feelings about earning money from your blog. If you believe that using your ‘passion’ to earn money is ‘wrong’ then you first need to decide whether you do want to use your blog to earn a living or not. Once you commit yourself though, the sky—literally—is the limit.

Commitment not only involves a desire and willingness to be a professional blogger, it also means being consistent with your postings. A blog is a service. Albeit, in many cases a free one but nevertheless it serves an audience. In one sense you could consider your site visitors as ‘customers’ who ‘pay’ you by visiting your site. This means that you have to be consistent in your postings to attract an audience.

Once you begin posting regularly you will attract an audience of readers who will form the initial base. This trickle of readers will continue to evolve and grow and many will come to your blog expecting fresh content on each visit. This expectation of your audience you can control to some extent by deciding how often you are going to post. Remember that it is difficult to scale back from posting several times a day to once a day to several times a week without having an impact on your readership.